

THE ELASTIC DOG NECKERCHIEF

— ♦ *Handmade goods for cozy little adventures* ♦ —

SIZES XS-XL · TWO PATTERN PIECES · STRAIGHT LINES ONLY

A lined kerchief with a folded neckband, so it pulls on over the head — no ties to knot and nothing that can tighten at the throat. Two pieces, every edge straight: the body is drawn with a ruler, and the band is a single long strip.

A PEEK AT THE FINISHED THING



Worn, and off the dog — the point centred, the band gathering softly at the neck. Fully reversible: two fabrics, no wrong side, so it wears either way round.

LEVEL

First project

TIME

About 45 minutes

SEAM ALLOWANCE

½" throughout

◆ SIZE CHART

Measure the neck where the collar sits, snug but level. Between sizes, take the larger. The band is $4\frac{1}{2}$ " wide in every size — only its length changes.

SIZE	FITS NECK	BODY, TOP × LONG	SIDES	BAND	ELASTIC
XS	8–11"	$6\frac{1}{2}$ " × $5\frac{1}{2}$ "	1"	$4\frac{1}{2}$ × 12"	4"
S	11–14"	8" × 7"	$1\frac{1}{4}$ "	$4\frac{1}{2}$ × 15"	5"
M	14–18"	$10\frac{1}{2}$ " × $8\frac{1}{2}$ "	$1\frac{3}{4}$ "	$4\frac{1}{2}$ × 19"	$6\frac{1}{2}$ "
L · DRAFTED HERE	18–22"	12" × 10"	2"	$4\frac{1}{2}$ × 22"	8"
XL	22–26"	14" × 12"	$2\frac{1}{2}$ "	$4\frac{1}{2}$ × 26"	10"

◆ CUT LIST

Written out at size L, for an 18 to 22" neck — for any other size, swap in its numbers from the chart above and the steps stay identical. **Every measurement includes the $\frac{1}{2}$ " seam allowance**, so cut exactly what the list says. Press your fabric first and cut with the long edges on the straight grain.

PIECE	CUT SIZE	HOW MANY	WHAT IT BECOMES
A · BODY	12" top edge × 10" long, 2" straight sides	Cut 2	the kerchief — outer and lining
B · NECKBAND	$4\frac{1}{2}$ " × 22"	Cut 1	the folded strap across the neck
C · ELASTIC	$\frac{3}{8}$ " wide × 8"	Cut 1	the stretch behind the neck

Finished: front edge 11" · drop about $8\frac{1}{2}$ " · neckband loop about 27" relaxed, stretching to about 33"

♦ FABRIC AND NOTIONS

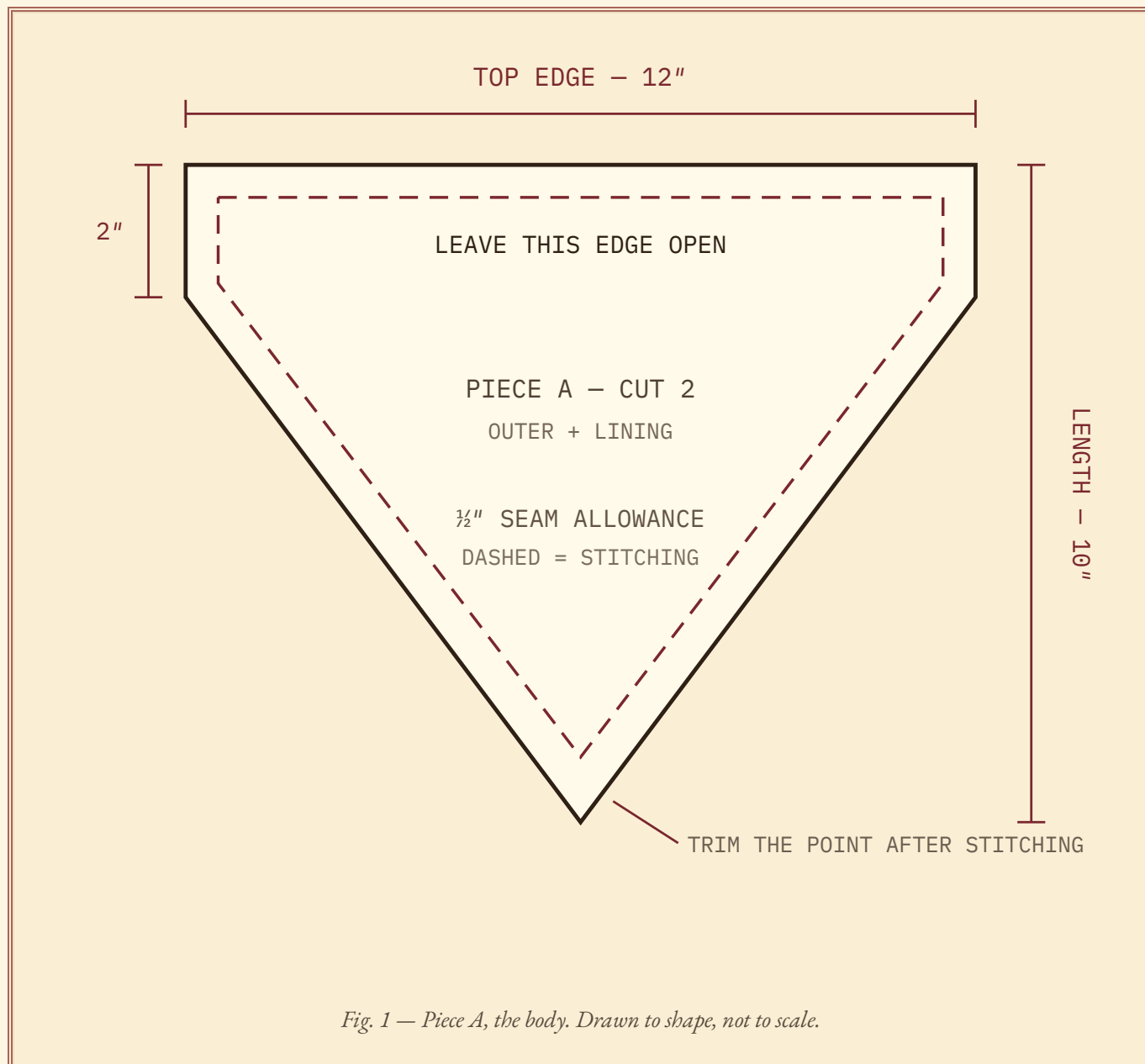
- **Outer fabric** — one fat quarter (18 × 22") of quilting cotton for sizes XS to M. Cotton, linen and chambray all behave; avoid anything stretchy or slippery.
- **A note on the one in the photograph** — its outer is pieced from scraps, which is why it reads as patchwork. A single fat quarter works just as well and the pattern is written for that; piece the outer first if you fancy it, press the seams flat, then treat the result as one piece of fabric and carry on from the cut list.
-  **Sizes L and XL need ½ yard, not a fat quarter.** Their bands are 22" and 26" long, and a fat quarter is only 22" across — L would use every last thread of it and XL simply will not fit. A ½ yard cut is 44" wide, so the band comes off the width with room to spare.
- **Lining fabric** — the same amount again in a contrast print. The kerchief is reversible, so pick something you would happily show.
- **Elastic** — 8" of 3/8"-wide braided or knit elastic for size L; see the chart for other sizes.
- **Thread** — all-purpose polyester in a colour that disappears into the outer fabric.
- **Tools** — ruler, fabric pen or tailor's chalk, scissors, pins or clips, iron, and a chopstick for the point.

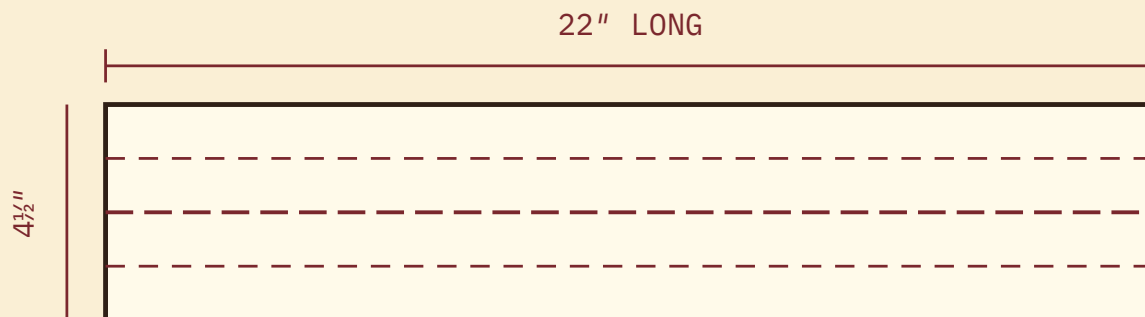
♦ WORDS THIS PATTERN USES

RIGHT SIDES TOGETHER	The two printed faces are facing each other, so the seam ends up hidden inside.
SEAM ALLOWANCE	The strip between the cut edge and the stitching. Here it is always ½" — line the cut edge up with the ½" mark on your machine's plate.
BACKSTITCH	Two or three stitches in reverse at the start and end of a seam, so it cannot unravel.
TOPSTITCH	A line of stitching sewn on the outside, close to an edge, where it is meant to be seen.

◆ DRAFT THE BODY

Lay the outer fabric flat, wrong side up. Rule a 12" line for the top edge, then drop a 2" line straight down at each end — those short sides keep the neck edge from collapsing. Mark the centre of the top edge and measure 10" straight down from it: that is the point. Join each 2" corner to the point, cut just inside your lines, then use the piece as a template for the lining.

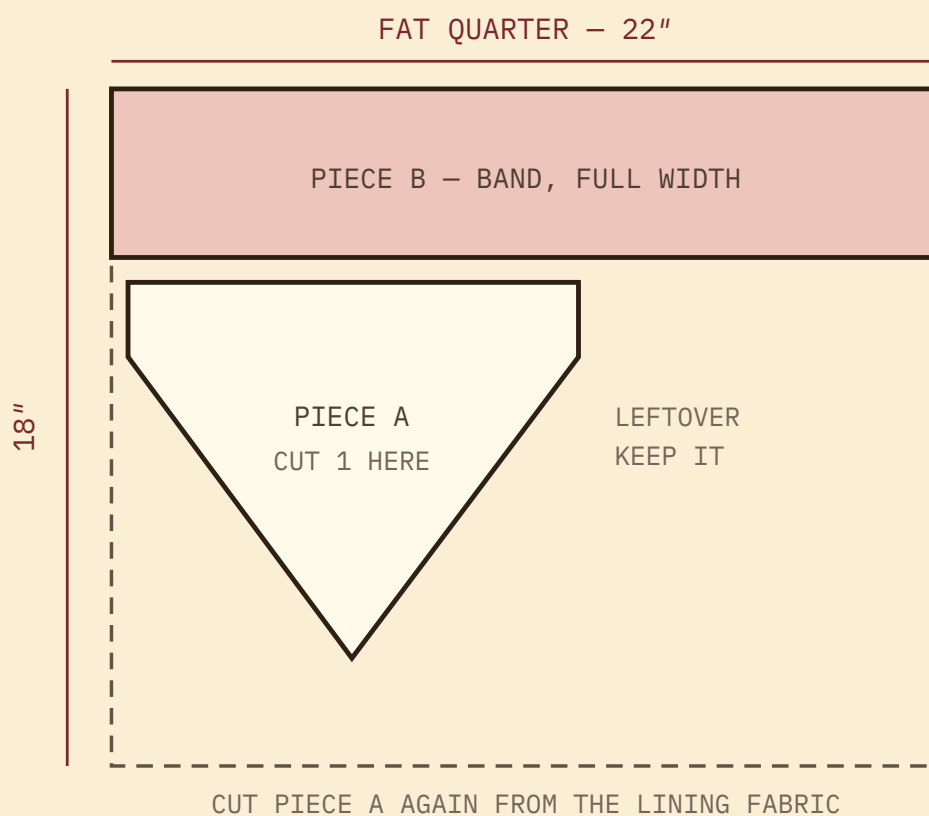




PIECE B – CUT 1

PRESS LONG EDGES TO THE CENTRE CREASE, THEN FOLD IN HALF

Fig. 2 — Piece B, the neckband. The heavy dash is the centre crease.

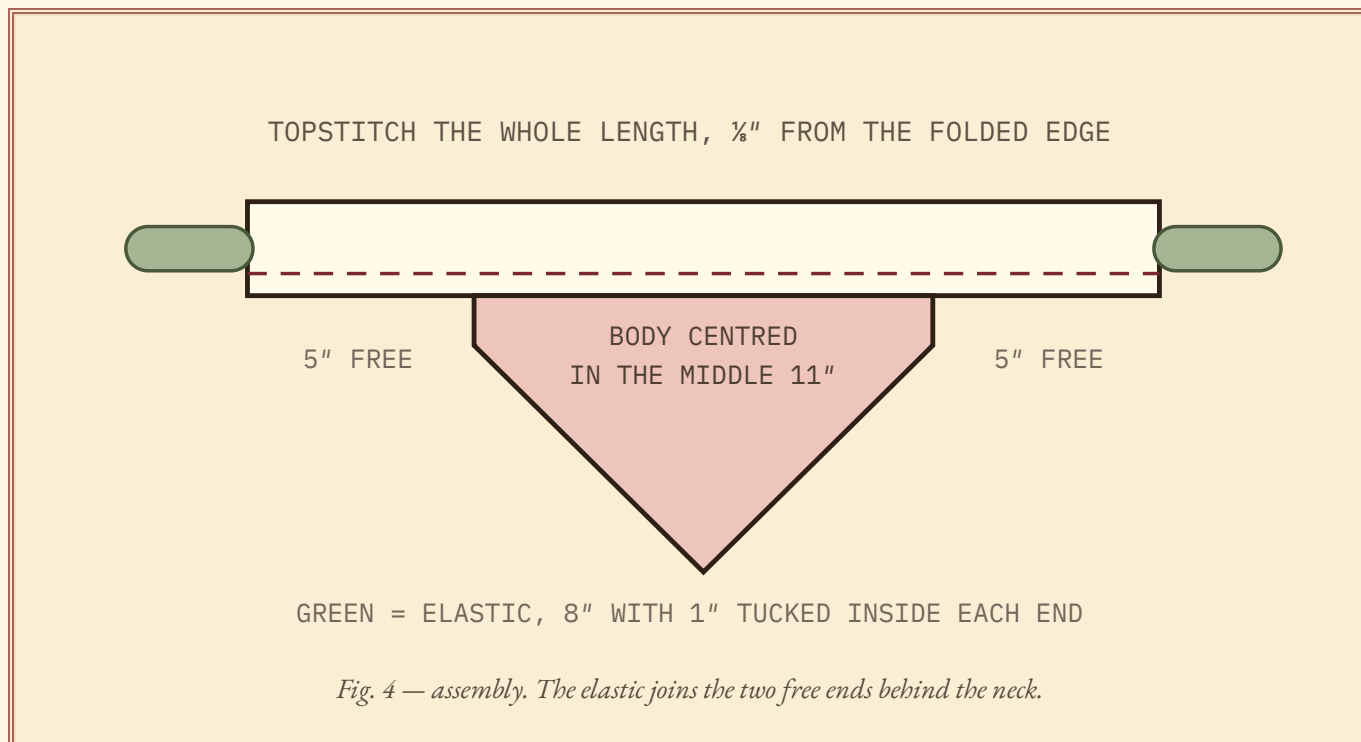


*Fig. 3 — the layout on one fat quarter, which fits sizes XS to M. **L and XL need ½ yard**: cut the band along the 44\"*



◆ SEW IT

1. Pin the two body pieces right sides together, cut edges flush. Leave the 12" top edge unpinned.
2. Stitch a $\frac{1}{2}$ " seam all the way round from one top corner to the other — down the 2" side, along the long angled edge, across the point, and back up the other side. Backstitch at both ends and leave the top edge open.
3. Snip the point off at an angle about $\frac{1}{8}$ " outside the stitching, and trim the seam allowances to $\frac{1}{4}$ " for the last 2" either side of it. This is what gives a sharp point instead of a lump.
4. Turn right side out through the open top. Ease the point out with the blunt end of a chopstick, then press flat, rolling the seams so neither fabric shows on the other's face.
5. Take the band. Press it in half lengthwise and open it out again. Press each long raw edge in to meet that centre crease, then fold the whole strip in half along the crease and press once more — you now have a four-layer strap a little over 1" wide, open along one long edge.
6. Tuck $\frac{1}{2}$ " of each short end of the band inside itself and press, so both ends are closed and neat. The band is now 21" long.
7. Slide 1" of one end of the elastic in between the layers at one end of the band; do the same with the other end of the elastic at the other end, leaving 6" showing between them. The elastic now bridges the two ends in a loop. Clip it in place.
8. Find the centre of the band and the centre of the body's top edge. Slip the body's raw top edge up inside the band's open edge, centred: its 11" finished edge inside the 21" finished band leaves 5" of band free on each side. Clip along the whole band.
9. Topstitch the full 21" length of the band $\frac{1}{8}$ " from its open folded edge, catching the body in the middle 11" and the elastic at both ends. Backstitch at each end, then stitch a small square back and forth over each elastic join.
10. Slip it over your dog's head to check the fit before the final press — it should go on easily and sit loose enough for two fingers under the band.



✦ VARIATION — TIES INSTEAD OF ELASTIC

Cut the band 34" long instead of 22" and leave the elastic out. The construction is identical: the body still sits in the middle 11", which leaves 11" of finished strap on each side to tie in a loose bow at the side of the neck. Never at the throat, and take it off when the dog is unsupervised.

✦ FIT, SAFETY AND WASHING

- Two fingers should slide comfortably under the band. If the elastic has to be tugged over the ears, unpick one join and add an inch.
- Take it off for crates, car rides and unsupervised time. An elastic neckband can catch on things.
- Prewash your fabric if you want it to stay this size — quilting cotton shrinks about 3% on its first wash.
- Machine wash cool, tumble low or line dry: hot water kills elastic. Press on the reverse and keep the iron off the elastic itself.
- No buttons, beads or dangling trims. Anything that can be chewed off eventually will be.